



INDIAN INSTITUTE OF SPACE SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY INDIA'S MOMENTOUS JOURNEY IN THE SPACE RACE

In the early sixties, when two most powerful nations of the world were engaged in a fierce Space Race, India quietly embarked on a momentous journey. Vikram Sarabhai, a great visionary and the father of India's space programme, strongly believed in the use of advanced technologies for the benefit of common man, in distinct contrast to the agenda of the super powers. The last four decades saw the Indian space program making great strides towards its avowed goal, silencing the cynics who considered it as too ambitious and unaffordable for a developing country. The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) now has a blueprint of ambitious high technology programmes for the future, which naturally banks on the finest of human resources, equipped with the right knowledge, skills and attitude. The idea of an academic institution offering high quality education in Space Science, Technology and Applications, originated from this vision of the future. In other words, the Indian Institute of Space Science and Technology (IIST) is simply, an idea whose time has come!

Established in the academic year 2007-08, IIST is a Deemed University with the following academic programmes:

1. Undergraduate programme (B Tech) in Aerospace Engineering, Avionics and Physical Sciences.

2. Post Graduate programme (M Tech) in advanced technology areas like RF & Microwave, Soft Computing and Machine Learning, Chemical Systems and Applied & Adaptive Optics.
3. Doctoral and Post-Doctoral Programmes in niche areas of Space Science and Technology.

Special Features of IIST

■ ABSORPTION IN ISRO

Students who complete the undergraduate programme in four years with a Cumulative Grade Point Average of 6.5, measured on a scale of 10, would be absorbed in ISRO as Scientist/Engineer SC. All such successful students will have to serve ISRO for a minimum period of five years, after which they are free to continue their service in ISRO.

■ ASSISTANCESHIP PACKAGE AT IIST

IIST is a fully residential Institute, where the complete cost of education, including Boarding and Lodging charges will be borne by the Institute through an Assistance Package, starting from the first semester. The Assistance Package to the students will also include a book grant of Rs.3000 per semester and an insurance cover for emergency medical care. Continuation of Assistance Package



INTALKWITH

DR. B. N. SURESH
FOUNDER DIRECTOR, IIST

Dr. B. N. Suresh is the founder Director of IIST. An eminent space scientist and the former Director of Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre, Dr. Suresh speaks about his vision of IIST

■ How is IIST different from other academic institutions offering similar courses?

In many respects, IIST is a very unique institution. It is Asia's first Space University and the first in the world to offer programmes from Undergraduate to Post-Doctoral level with specific focus to space science and technology, under one roof. The students of IIST can hugely benefit from access to sophisticated high technology laboratories and facilities of ISRO, apart from its own advanced state-of-the-art infrastructure. I can say with absolute confidence that IIST is well on its way to becoming a world-class centre of learning in Space Science and Technology.

■ How is your curriculum structured?

While designing the courses the generic character of Science and Engineering has been carefully retained, but specific focus is given to applications in space science and technology wherever necessary. A good blend of science and engineering subjects has also been brought while structuring the courses. Similarly laboratory experiments are devised to give more exposure to real life experiments with the help of ISRO Centres and Units.

■ When are you planning to move to your new campus and is it fully residential?

We are working hard to move to the new campus by March 2010. The entire infrastructure of the new campus is expected to be ready by end of 2010. The Institute is planned to be fully residential and all needed infrastructure are being planned in the campus.